

Public Forum 101

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What is public forum debate?

- Partner debate (2 vs. 2)
- Debating a resolution
 - Each side either *affirms* or *negates*
- Judge evaluates the winner of each round
- Evidence-based
 - Pre-written cases & pre-written responses to common arguments
- Topics are usually related to politics, international relations, economics, etc.



Round Structure + Speeches

What is Speaker Position?

- Each partner has specific speeches they give
- 1st speaker (case, 1st cross, summary, grand cross)
- 2nd speaker (rebuttal, 2nd cross, grand cross, final focus)



Structure of a Round

Coin flip!

1. Pro case (4 minutes)
2. Con case (4 minutes)
3. First cross (3 minutes)
4. Pro rebuttal (4 minutes)
5. Con rebuttal (4 minutes)
6. Second cross (3 minutes)
7. Pro summary (3 minutes)
8. Con summary (3 minutes)
9. Grand cross (3 minutes)
10. Pro final focus (2 minutes)
11. Con final focus (2 minutes)



Case

- The first speech in a round
- 4 minute pre-written explanation of your arguments
- Pro reads their case for 4 minutes, then Con reads theirs for 4 minutes
- Read by the first speaker



First Cross

- Comes right after second case is read, whoever spoke first gets the first question – cross is **only for questions and responses**, no responding to responses!
- Only first speakers can speak
- Pro and con ask each other questions about their arguments back and forth for 3 minutes
 - “How does _____ cause ___?” “What is the impact of ___?”
 - Clarify anything you did not understand or missed during their speech
 - If there are inconsistencies in things they have said, you can ask strategic “attack” questions to try to get concessions out of them that will help your side
- **Pro tip:** circle anything you were confused about while you flow or write down your questions while they read case so you remember to ask them in cross



Rebuttal

- 4 minute response to what the other team said in their case- tell the judge why your opponents' arguments do not stand
 - Because Con goes second, the Con rebuttal does not only respond to the Pro case, but also to the Pro's rebuttal (frontlining)
- Given by the second speaker
- You will start on their first contention and respond to it (explain why it is wrong), then go to the next one
- Rebuttals use blocks (quoted evidence) to prove why they are right in saying that the other team is wrong
 - Remember to WARRANT (explain why the evidence supports your argument)



Second Cross

- Comes right after second rebuttal is read
- Only second speakers can speak
- Side that spoke first gets first question
- Pro and con ask each other questions about their arguments back and forth for 3 minutes



Summary

- 3 minutes
- “Crystallizing” key points
- You don’t have to (and shouldn’t) cover everything that was said in the round– summarize the main arguments made in a round, elaborate on most important arguments and respond to points made in opponents’ rebuttal
- Common to *collapse* (only try to win one of your contentions and drop the other if you are losing it– but don’t have to)
- *Extend* your argument
 - re-explain the *link chain* (i.e. flow of logic and evidence that leads to your impacts)– briefly re-explain your argument and why it is true
- *Frontline* (rebuild) the arguments you are extending– responding to opponents’ rebuttal
- Extend responses to other team’s case
- WEIGH (we have another slide to explain this)



Summary continued

- One way to organize summary:
 - Extend your case
 - Frontline your arguments
 - Respond to opponents' case
 - Weigh impacts



Weighing

- Compare your impacts to your opponent's impacts—why are your impacts more important?
- Use *weighing mechanisms*
 - **Magnitude:** my impact is bigger than your impact
 - How severe the impact is in terms of size
 - **Timeframe:** short-term vs long-term impacts
 - **Scope:** how broad the impact is (ex. Affects many different groups of people instead of just one)
 - **Probability:** how likely an impact is



Grand Cross

- Comes after second summary
- Between all four speakers!! (side that spoke first still gets first question)
- Typical debate image – 4 people all talking over each other
- Try to keep this calm and speak one at a time – remember that cross is only for questions!! (this applies to first and second cross as well) They cannot answer your question with a question (i.e. don't let them try to turn responding to your question into just re-explaining their arguments if that's not what you're asking)
 - “that is not a question”
 - “let me finish” and “don't interrupt me”– stand your ground and don't let opponents talk over you and be rude



Final Focus

- 2 minutes
- Identify the main points of clash and what has been contested
- Voter points!
- Numbering is your best friend
- Extend your case's links and all of your impacts you are going for
 - If there is anything they contested very strongly – restating it might hurt you
- Extend important frontlines + responses to your opponents' case
- WEIGH WEIGH WEIGH – reserve at least a whole minute for this!



Prep Time

- This is the time you use to prepare your rebuttal, summary, and final focus speeches
- You are NOT writing out full speeches during this time- speeches are given on the fly, so prep time serves to create an outline for what you will cover in your speeches
 - However, especially for rebuttals, multiple cards are read during a speech, and those you can copy and paste onto a doc to read (doc examples)
- You can use prep time at any point in the round, but best to use prep right before your speech (i.e. if you are speaking second, take prep time before your rebuttal, not before theirs, because then you are giving them extra prep time)
- You also prep while your opponents are taking prep time
- Most tournaments- 3 minutes of prep time per team



Let's look at an example



PUBLIC FORUM DEBATE FINAL ROUND



Resolved: In the United States, social media is beneficial for democratic values.

Advanced Note-taking/Flowing

Aff Case	Neg rebuttal	Aff Summary
<u>C1:</u>		
• Claim		
• Claim	→ Counterpoint (de-link)	
• Reason/Warrant	• Evidence • evidence	
• Evidence		
• Evidence		
• Impact	→ Turn *Weighing*	
<u>C2:</u>		
• Claim	→ De-link	*Frontline*
• Warrant		
• Evidence		→ Evidence
• Warrant		
• Evidence		
• Impact		→ Impacts
• Impact		
• Impact		*Weighing*

have terror in a year Prescott 15	WORLD MICHAEL 12	EXT PRES TV 15 more possible today than ever. their ev is outdated	EXT MICHAEL 12 sure comes from a counterpoint perspective
will use WPMs Schmidt 15	can't build trust MICHAEL 12 no resources to get WPMs MICHAEL 12	EXT SCHMIDT 15 in bio chem on WPMs. their ev is only specific to WPMs	EXT MICHAEL 12 our evidence is specific to all WPMs
Overstating threat Thomson 15	new evidence make it less effective BARNACK 15	EXT THOMAS 15 overstating info	EXT BARNACK 15 his method of data collection is effective now
dirty bomb to nuclear + socio econ possible Dvorshin 12	schmidt reach false bc small sample MICHAEL 12	OUR EV IS SPECIFIC TO THIS SPECIALLY IN FINDING TERROR THREAT	
	NO VIEW OF NUCLEAR TERROR MICHAEL 12	EXT PRES TV 15 sheir ev is outdated	EXT MICHAEL 12 our ev is more credible
causes extinction via retaliation Ayson 10		conceded AYSON 10 seems in effect of terror we win first the plan cover extinction	
Limited capabilities triggers impact ATI 11		conceded ATI 11 this means even small terror plots can trigger the impact	
plan necessary to shift from mass to targeted surveillance Gonzalez/Schmidt 15		conceded Gonzalez/Schmidt 15 all we have to prove is that target surveillance is better than mass	
Only way to stop terror plots Schmidt 15	our analysis, it's not just terror threats	EXT THOMAS 15 can't effectively analyze data	EXT BARNACK 15 becoming more effective
		EXT SCHMIDT 15 targeted surveillance only way to stop terror	

Your Turn

Resolved: Students should be allowed to use phones in school.

